

Niklas Hlubek

Department of Datascience & Biostatistics
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Epidemiologist with interdisciplinary background in psychology and public health, specialized in health inequalities. Expertise in complex data linkage and applying advanced quantitative methods to large-scale registry cohort data.

EDUCATION

- PhD. **Epidemiology**, Utrecht University, Utrecht - NL, expected early 2026
MSc. **Social Policy and Public Health**, Utrecht University, Utrecht - NL, 2022
MSc. **Psychological Research**, University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh - SCO , 2021
BSc. **Psychology**, Erasmus University Rotterdam, Rotterdam - NL, 2019

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 2026 - **Statistical Programmer** - University Medical Center Utrecht - NL
- Contributing to implementation of target trial emulation study design and reviewing of statistical analysis plans
- Designing and developing analytic pipelines with data engineers, and supporting continuous improvement
- Processing, visualizing, evaluating, and reporting statistical results
- Contributing to teaching and research activities within the department
- 2023 - 25 **Doctoral Research Fellow** - University Medical Center Utrecht - NL
- Designed and executed advanced quantitative analyses on longitudinal registry cohort data (>70M observations) to investigate socioeconomic patterns in environmental health inequalities
- Independently developed and implemented comprehensive data linkage pipelines integrating multiple registry and environmental data sources, establishing robust harmonization protocols and quality assurance frameworks
- Authored peer-reviewed manuscripts (2 published, 3 under review) and presented findings at international conferences to academic and policy audiences
- 2024 **Research Consultant** - Municipality Utrecht, Utrecht - NL
- Delivered evidence-based case report on city-level environmental inequalities for policy stakeholders
- 2024 **Visiting Researcher** - ISGlobal Barcelona Institute for Global Health, Barcelona - ESP
- Advanced spatial epidemiology and clustering methodologies for population health research
- Managed the harmonization and analysis of data from 2 longitudinal European cohorts (BAMSE, PIAMA)

- 2022 **Policy and Projects Assistant** - Mental Health Europe, Brussels - BE
 - Organized co-production workshops with diverse stakeholders and conducted policy analysis on mental health policies across European countries
- 2020 **Research Assistant** - University Medical Center Hamburg Eppendorf, Hamburg - DE
 - Supported psychiatric interventions and contributed to clinical research protocols
- 2019 - 20 **Research Assistant** - Max Planck Institute for Cognitive and Brain Sciences, Leipzig - DE
 - Supporting research assistant in large double-blind randomized controlled trial

GRANTS

- 2023-25 **Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions ITN Fellowship**
 Full PhD fellowship within EU H2020 project SURREAL (surreal-itn.eu)

TEACHING & INVOLVEMENT

- 2024-25 **PhD Council Board Member**, Julius Center, University Medical Center Utrecht
 - Representative responsible for communication between PhD candidates and Division Leadership
- 2023-25 **Teaching Assistant**, Evidence Based Case Reports, Utrecht University Medical Center
 - Led interactive tutorials on evidence based reports methods for medical students

PUBLICATIONS

- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, , Koop Y., Verhoeven J., Wagtendonk A., Vienneau D., Vaartjes I., "Air pollution and ischemic stroke across socioeconomic groups in the Netherlands" *Science of The Total Environment*. Currently under review
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Gehring, U., J. Boer et al. "Assessing the impact of changes in home location on adolescent lung function: an exposome-wide natural experiment" *Environment International. Environmental Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.envres.2025.123132>.
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Wagtendonk A., Vaartjes I. "Area-level temporal trends in air pollution exposure across socioeconomic position groups in the Netherlands" *Health and Place*. Currently under review
- 2024 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Wagtendonk A., Vaartjes I. "Temporal Trends in Air Pollution Exposure across Socioeconomic Groups in the Netherlands." *Int. J. Environ. Res. Public Health*. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph21080976>..
- 2022 **Hlubek, N.**, Templeton, A., Wiseman-Gregg, K. "A social identity approach to COVID-19 transmission in hospital settings." *Journal of Applied Social Psychology*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jasp.12948>.
- 2022 Bomke P., **Hlubek, N.** "Entwicklung der Sozialpsychiatrie in Europa - die Sicht von Mental Health Europe" *Kerbe - Forum fuer soziale Psuychiatrie*.
- 2021 Moritz S., Xie J., Penney D., Biehl L., **Hlubek, N.**, Elmers J., Beblo T., Hottenrott B. "The magnitude of neurocognitive impairment is overestimated in depression: the role of motivation, debilitating momentary influences, and the overreliance on mean differences." *Psychological Medicine*. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0033291721004785>.
- 2020 Jelinek L., **Hlubek, N.**, Moritz S., Miegel F., Voderholzer U. "Zwangsstörungen während COVID-19: Sind Menschen mit Waschzwängen besonders betroffen." *z-aktuell*.

PRESENTATIONS

- 2025 **Hlubek, N.**, Koop Y., Verhoeven J., Wagtendonk A., Vienneau D., Vaartjes I., “Air pollution and ischemic stroke across socioeconomic groups in the Netherlands” Project presented at the **ESC Preventive Cardiology** Conference, Milano (2025)
- 2025 **Hlubek, N.** “Equity in exposure” Presentation at **UBD Policy Workshop on Equity in Health Impact Assessment** (ubdpolicy.eu), Utrecht (2025)
- 2024 **Hlubek, N.**, et al. “Impact of exposome relocation trajectories on childhood lung function” Project presented to the annual **EXPANSE meeting**, Munich (2024)
- 2022 Templeton A., **Hlubek, N.** “Social identity processes in hospital workers risk perception and adherence to safety guidance during the COVID-19 pandemic.” Paper presented at the **BPS Social Psychology Section Annual Conference**, Online (2022)
- 2021 **Hlubek, N.**, Templeton A. “A social identity approach to COVID-19 transmissions in hospital settings – Barriers and avenues to safe behavior in healthcare workers.” Project presented to the **Scottish Government COVID-19 Nosocomial Review Group**, Online (2021)

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

Statistical & Computing

Multilevel modeling
Survival/Time-to-event analysis
Causal Inference (DAGs, Propensity scores)
Spatial clustering methodology

Programming & Tools

R, Markdown/Quarto, SQL, Git/GitHub

Data management & Governance

ETL Automation, Data Quality Assurance
Registry linkage, Secure Research Environments
GDPR Compliance, Data Pseudonymisation

Languages

German (native), English (fluent)
Dutch (intermediate, B2)

RELEVANT TRAINING & WORKSHOPS

- 2024 **Introduction to Causal Inference and Causal Data Science**
Utrecht Summer School, Utrecht University
- 2024 **Supercomputing for social scientists with R**
ODISSEI Social Data Science Team, SURF Amsterdam
- 2023 **Modern Method in Data Analysis**
Graduate School of Life Sciences, Utrecht University